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The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original notes by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

THINK OVER

To know is to appreciate--is to love, and to adore. In things divine and to glory in the service of the known. What an outlook this ought to afford us! What an outstanding horizon--if, "Hope is the soul of happiness here and if the revealed purpose of our creation, "to know God" is kept in mind--what a horizon for poor sinners if we but stop to think and remember that to know God covers everything.

GOD MADE ME TO KNOW HIM. O what a bless'd aim!

To love Him and serve Him sure rests in the same.

It's "Heaven begun" for the grateful on earth;--

To treasure aright! Highest Heaven its worth.

But how can I know what the senses fail to perceive. How know the incomprehensible God whose attributes--wisdom and power and goodness and mercy--are infinite? A simple question demands, in the first place, a simple answer.

Do the senses perceive the electricity--the "juice" in a "live wire?" Or, do scientists peer into the sun to consider its wonderful benefits?

If the primary purpose of my creation is to know my Creator, so that I may be happy in His loving service; and if no one but a fool can say in his heart, "There is no God," then the conclusion would seem to be that God's existence must be manifest, one way or other, to everyone that is not a fool, that every normal person able to think can and ought to recognize his Creator--can and must worship God; and this under pain to losing everything good and of damning his own soul,--"cast out into exterior darkness where there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth."

However, in a matter of such tremendous importance it would be nothing less than criminal to be satisfied with the minimum. The foregoing is simply no answer at all to what we want and to what we'll have, please God. Self-understood there can be no thought of our knowing God in our present state directly and as He is known in Heaven. Our privilege here is to start such knowledge as can be perfected only in the great, Blessed Beyond. Nevertheless, if we stop to think as we ought to do; there must be ways and means close at hand whereby, according to the lives of the saints, we may if we try, ascend to great sanctity and to an astonishing familiarity with God even here as pilgrims to the Beatific Vision.